Ans. (c): The following jurisdictions fall under the original jurisdiction of the Supreme Court under Article 131.

- Dispute between the Government of India and one or more states.
- Dispute between two or more states.
- Disputes between the Government of India and any State or States on one side and one or more other States on the other.

41. The power to increase the number of judges in the Supreme Court of India is vested in-

(a) The President of India
(b) The Parliament
(c) The Chief Justice of India
(d) The Law Commission

Ans. (b): According to Article 124 (1) - There shall be a Supreme Court of India constituting of a Chief Justice of India and, until Parliament by law prescribes a larger number, of not more than seven other Judges. Parliament increased the number of judges from the original 8 in 1950 to 11 in 1956, 14 in 1960, 18 in 1978, 26 in 1986, 31 in 2008 and to 34 in 2019.

• Panchayati Raj System and Constitution Amendments and Schedules

42. Which one of the following Schedules of the Constitution of India contains provisions regarding anti-defection?

(a) Second Schedule (b) Fifth Schedule
(c) Eight Schedule (d) Tenth Schedule

Ans. (d): The Anti-Defection Act was passed on 30th March, 1985. The provision of disqualification of membership on the grounds of defection has been implemented under the 10th schedule by the 52nd Constitution Amendment in the Indian constitution in 1985.

ECONOMIC

• Economic Planning and National Income/Budget

43. The main objective of the 12th five year Plan was-

(a) Inclusive growth and poverty reduction.
(b) Inclusive and sustainable growth.
(c) Sustainable and inclusive growth to reduce unemployment.
(d) Faster, sustainable and more inclusive growth.

Ans. (d): The objective of the 12th Five Year Plan (2012-17) was faster, sustainable and more inclusive growth. Five-Year Plans (FYPs) were centralised economic and social growth programs.

44. What are the benefits of implementing the 'Integrated Watershed Development Programme'?

1. Prevention of soil runoff
2. Linking the country' perennial rivers with seasonal rivers
3. Rainwater harvesting and recharge of groundwater table
4. Regeneration of natural vegetation

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 1,2,3 and 4

Ans. (c): Under the Integrated Watershed Development Programme' several goals such as prevention of overflow of soil, rainwater harvesting and recharge of groundwater have been prescribed. The Integrated Watershed Development Board was established in the year 1985. It works under the ministry of Environment, Forest and climate change.

45. With reference to Union Budget, which of the following is/are covered under Non Plan Expenditure?

1. Defence expenditure 2. Interest payments
3. Salaries and pensions 4. Subsidies

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (d) None

Ans. (c): All the above dependence expenditure, interest payments, salaries and pensions and Subsidies form the part of Non-plan expenditure.

• Agriculture, Industry and Trade

46. What are the significances of a practical approach to sugarcane production known as 'Sustainable Sugarcane Initiative' ?

1. Seed cost is very low in this compared to the conventional method of cultivation
2. Drip irrigation can be practiced very effectively in this.
3. There is no application of chemical/inorganic fertilizers at all in this.
4. The scope for intercropping is more in this compared to the conventional method of cultivation.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 4
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b) The SSI method encourages the application of organic manure as it enhances the macro and micronutrient content in the soil in an eco- friendly way and helps in optimum utilization of some of the chemical fertilizers.

47. In India, cluster bean (Guar) is traditionally used as a vegetable or animal feed, but recently the cultivation of this has assumed significance. Which one of the following statements is correct in this context ?

(a) The oil extracted from seeds is used in the manufacture of biodegradable plastics.
(b) The gum made from its seed is used in the extraction of shale gas.
(c) The leaf extract of this plant has the properties of anti-histamines.
(d) It is a source of high quality biodiesel.

Ans. (b): Cluster bean (Guar) is native to India and is widely grown in dry, warm and arid regions. It is a source of Guar gum. It is derived from guar seeds, a legume crop that grows in semi-arid regions of Rajasthan Gujarat and Haryana.
It is traditionally used as a vegetable or animal feed.
The gum made from its seeds is used in the extraction of shale gas. Guar gum is used as a stabilizing thickening and suspending agent in drilling fluids. India is the world's largest producer of guar.

48. Consider the following pairs :

Region	Well-known for the production of
Kinnaur	Areca nut
Mewat	Mango
Coromandel	Soya bean

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None

Ans. (d): Kinnaur (Himachal Pradesh) is famous for apples. Areca nut is mostly confined to Karnataka, Kerala and Assam . Mewat in Haryana is not famous for mango. U.P. is famous for mango. Similarily, the Coromandel coast is not famous for Soybeans. The top two producers of Soybeans are Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra, which are outside the Coromandel coast. Therefore (d) is the correct option.

49. Consider the following statements :

1. Maize can be used for the production of starch.
2. Oil extracted from maize can be a feedstock for biodiesel.
3. Alcoholic beverages can be produced by using maize.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): All three statements are correct as Maize can be used for the production of starch. Oil extracted from maize can be used as a feedstock for biodiesel. Alcoholic beverages can be produced by using maize.

50. In the context of food and nutritional security of India, enhancing the 'Seed Replacement Rates' of various crops helps in achieving the food production targets of the future. But what is/ are the constraints /constraints in its wider/greater implementation?

1. There is no National Seed Policy in place.
2. There is no participation of private sector seed companies in the supply of quality seeds of vegetables and planting materials of horticultural crops.
3. There is a demand-supply gap regarding quality seeds in case of low value and high volume crops.

Select the correct answer using the code given below

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) None

Ans. (b): The Government of India had announced the National Seed Policy in the year 2000 to achieve the future food targets, under which the government in collaboration with the private sector, will try to bridge the gap in demand and supply of quality seeds in relation to a low value and high volume crops.

• Money/Banking, Tax System, Centre-State Relations

51. The sales tax you pay while purchasing a toothpaste is a -

(a) Tax imposed by the Central Government.
(b) Tax imposed by the Central Government but collected by the State Government.
(c) Tax imposed by the State Government but collected by the Central Government.
(d) Tax imposed and collected by the state Government.

Ans. (d): Taxes on toothpaste comes under CST Act, which is administered by the state Government. Sales Tax is paid to the Sales Tax Authority in the state form where the goods are moved, i.e., the state from where the movement of goods begins.

52. What does venture capital mean ?

(a) A short-term capital provided to industries.
(b) A long-term start-up capital provided to new entrepreneurs.
(c) Funds provided to industries at times of incurring losses.
(d) Funds provided for replacement a renovation of industries.

Ans. (b): Venture Capital (VC) is a long term financial capital provided to early-stage high potential growth startup companies on new companies.

53. With reference to Balance of Payments, which of the following constitutes/constitute the Current Account ?

1. Balance of trade
2. Foreign assets
3. Balance of invisibles
4. Special Drawing Rights

Select the correct answer using the code given below

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 4

Ans. (c): Current account includes the balance of trade (exports-imports), net remittances, trade-in services.

54. The terms ' Marginal Standing Facility Rate' and 'Net Demand and Time Liabilities', sometimes appearing in news, are used in relation to

(a) Banking operations
(b) Communication networking
(c) Military strategies
(d) Supply and demand of agricultural products.

Ans. (a): MSF came into effect from 9th May 2011. MSF scheme is provided by RBI by which the banks can borrow overnight upto 1 percent of their Net Demand and Time Liabilities (NDTL) i.e, 1 percent of the aggregate deposits and other liabilities of the banks.